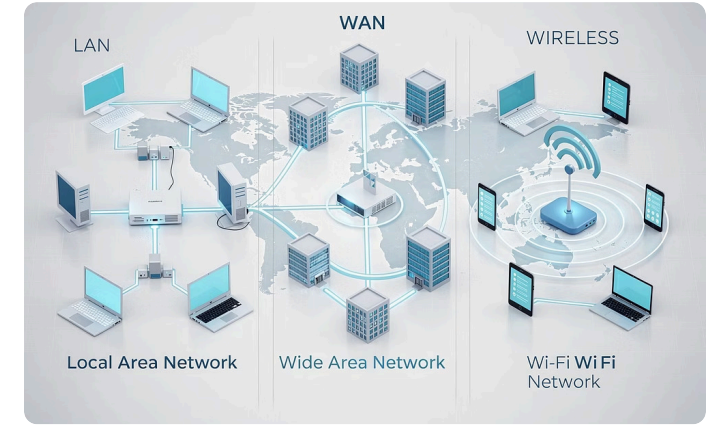




# 16) Types of networks

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Apart from the basic distinction between **peer-to-peer** and **client-server**, computer networks can also be classified according to their size. They are identified by acronyms and the most common types are **LAN** and **WAN**.

- 1 PAN**  
For data transmission among devices such as computers, tablets, smartphones, etc., belonging to the same person, at an average range of about 10 metres. The connection can be **wireless**.
- 2 LAN**  
It operates within a limited **geographical area**, usually the same building, with **cables**, **wireless**, infrared or **microwave** links. It is controlled privately by a local administrator. It provides full time connectivity to local services and allows multi-access to **high-speed** with media.
- 3 MAN**  
A data network designed for a city or suburban **geographical area**. It usually consists of two or more **LANs** in a common **geographical area**.
- 4 WAN**  
It covers a large area, between cities, countries and continents. It connects **LANs** to each other. Computers are connected by **high-speed** telephone lines, **fibre optical cables**, **microwave** and **satellite** links
- 5 GAN**  
The network extends all over the world and includes: the **Internet**, University and Research networks, and military networks.



# Virtual Private Network

A **Virtual Private Network (VPN)**, which is the most **cost-effective** method to establish a **point-to-point** connection between remote users and a **company's network**, is a **private network** which is set up online using the **Internet** as a method of connection.

There are three main types of **VPNs**:



## Intranet VPNs

to link **subsidiaries** or **branches** to a company's internal network through a **dedicated connection** and with access granted only to the company's **employees**;



## Extranet VPNs

to link people external to the company and to whom access is granted, to a company's internal network through a **dedicated connection**;



## Access VPNs

to provide **remote access** to the company's Intranet or Extranet, from home or from a small office.



YouTube



**Network Types: LAN, WAN, PAN, CAN, MAN, SAN, WLAN**

Network types depend on how large they are and how much of an area they cover geographically. This video explains the difference between a LAN vs WAN, along wit...